

experiences have become his story and a driving force behind creating and growing *ChooseFI* as a platform to expose others to a better way of life.

Many of us start our journeys to FI fed up by stress, busyness, and general discontent with a life that revolves around going to a job to make money. So without much thought, we desire the opposite—retirement.

When Fritz Gilbert of *The Retirement Manifesto* spoke with Brad and Jonathan on the podcast, he asked, “How much more interesting would your job be if you’re just doing it because you want to do it?” Work provides a lot of the things that make us happy, from income to personal development to providing an outlet to serve others, giving meaning and purpose to our lives. Fritz said that as you contemplate this, you realize, “The work that you thought sucked so much doesn’t suck so much anymore.”

Many in the FI community have come to the same conclusion. We continue to do meaningful and paid work in “retirement” even though we don’t really need the money. Some criticize people who write about FIRE, saying we’re “not really retired.” *Mr. Money Mustache* labels these people the “Internet Retirement Police.” They find it offensive that we don’t meet their definition of retirement (i.e.,